

RoamWise

Travel planning that knows the local price.

An India-first travel planner with something no competitor has: the fair price of an auto-rickshaw, the specific scam you will meet at the station, and an itinerary that opens with no signal.

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195+ countries covered · 66 releases shipped · 1 person building it

01 — THE PROBLEM

Travellers do not lack inspiration. They lack local knowledge.

Every AI trip planner produces the same output: a confident list of the same six places, in the same voice, with "budget-friendly" where a number should be.

- No real prices — "affordable" is not a number. Travellers get quoted 3x the local rate because they have no idea what the rate is.
- Confident hallucination — LLM planners routinely invent restaurants and recommend places that closed years ago.
- Useless offline — the moment you most need your itinerary is usually the moment you have no data.
- Western-centric — built for someone flying into Rome, not someone taking a sleeper from Delhi.

02 — INSIGHT

The gap is not intelligence. It is ground truth.

Anyone can generate a Goa itinerary. Almost nobody can tell you the auto to Anjuna should cost ₹180, that "your hotel is closed" is a commission scam, and then show you all of it with the phone in airplane mode.

Generic travel advice is now free and infinite. What remains scarce — and defensible — is verified local economic knowledge. That is a data moat, not a model moat, and it compounds.

03 — PRODUCT

What RoamWise does that others do not

- **Ground-cost engine** — Auto ₹25–35 base + ₹15–20/km. Bike taxi ₹10–15/km. Rooms, meals and intercity fares across India, SE Asia and Europe.

- **Anti-scam layer** — The mechanics of each trick: meter refusal, commission runs, passport-as-deposit, currency conversion at the card machine.
- **Offline-first** — Saved trips, guides, maps and costs open with no connectivity. Survives a dead CDN.
- **Carbon ledger** — Published DEFRA/IPCC factors, earned badges, shareable certificate — stating emissions avoided, never "removed".
- **Crowd calendar** — Month-by-month crowd index per destination. Timing changes trip quality more than any other decision.
- **Situational safety** — Pharmacies, rabies protocol, monkey hotspots in hill towns — the things that actually go wrong.

04 — COMPETITION

Know your competitors

Capability	Mindtrip	Layla	Wanderlog	Google	RoamWise
AI itinerary	Yes	Yes	Partial	Yes	Yes
Local fair-price data	No	No	No	No	Yes
Scam / overcharge warnings	No	No	No	No	Yes
Works fully offline	No	No	Partial	No	Yes
India-first depth	No	No	No	Partial	Yes
Carbon ledger	No	No	No	Partial	Yes
Pricing	Subscription	Subscription	Freemium	Free (ads)	One-time

Assessment July 2026 from public product surfaces. Competitors ship fast — re-verify quarterly. The claim is not that they cannot build this, but that it takes years of field data they have no reason to collect.

05 — WHY THE MOAT HOLDS

A model is rentable. Ground truth is not.

- **They optimise for coverage** — A global planner cannot afford to know that Rishikesh autos overcharge at Ram Jhula. RoamWise is worth more precisely because it goes narrow first.
- **Grounded, not generated** — Answers are built from Wikivoyage, OpenStreetMap and curated cost models — so it can decline instead of inventing a restaurant.
- **Costs scale with users, not AI** — Free data sources. No per-query inference bill. Gross margin does not degrade with growth.
- **Trust compounds** — Every honest refusal — no fake urgency, no invented safety claims — is a reason a traveller returns.

06 — MARKET

India is the fastest-growing large travel market on earth

2.5B+ domestic trips a year · ~30M outbound travellers · \$6.4T global travel economy

The wedge is Indian travellers planning within India and Asia — underserved by Western tools, price-sensitive, mobile-first, and accustomed to paying once rather than subscribing. The same product then serves anyone travelling into these regions.

Figures indicative, from published tourism-ministry and WTTC reporting. Verify independently.

07 — BUSINESS MODEL

Four revenue lines, none of them a data sale

- **One-time Pro** — ₹100 founder price capped at 1,000 members, then tiered subscriptions and 3/5/10-year passes. Prices held one year, reviewed annually.
- **Affiliate commission** — Flights, stays, activities. Never influences recommendations — the cost engine computes identically either way.
- **Merchandise** — Print-on-demand travel tees. ₹499 retail, ~₹172 margin, zero inventory.
- **Advertising** — Website only. Never inside the app experience.

No data sale · No paid placement · No dark patterns

08 — TRACTION

Shipped, not slideware

- 66 releases — Android app live, PWA live, admin console, agent tooling. Built and shipped by one person.
- Full stack in production — Firestore with rule-level security, offline service worker, R8-minified builds, signed AAB on Play.
- Content engine — 32 indexed pages, 16,000+ words of original guides driving organic acquisition at zero CAC.
- Creator programme — tiered partner ladder: trial, then revenue share, then lifetime. Earned, not gifted.

v1 to v66, solo. The constraint has never been capability. It has been hours.

What this category has raised

Company	Reported raised	Where	Model
Mindtrip	~\$12M seed +	US	Subscription
Layla	~\$10M (incl. Roam Around)	EU / US	Subscription
Wanderlog	Y Combinator + seed	US	Freemium
GuideGeek (Matador)	Backed by parent group	US	Free / B2B
RoamWise	Bootstrapped — ₹0 raised	India	One-time + affiliate

Reported figures — verify on Crunchbase or Tracxn before quoting live. An investor who catches a wrong number stops trusting the rest of the deck.

They raised eight figures to build the layer RoamWise already has — and still do not have the local-price and offline layers. This was built to v66 on nothing.

10 — THE ASK

₹4 crore (≈ \$480K) for 18 months

Deliberately not a \$10M round. This is the amount that removes the actual constraint, and nothing beyond it.

Allocation	Amount	What it buys
Field data operations	₹1.6 Cr	Paid local contributors verifying cost bands and scam patterns across 40 Indian cities, then SE Asia. This is the moat and it is funded first.
Two engineers, 18 months	₹1.2 Cr	iOS native, regional languages, and removing the founder as the single point of failure.
Distribution	₹0.8 Cr	First real marketing spend, creator partnerships, content scaling on the channel already converting at zero CAC.
Runway buffer	₹0.4 Cr	Infrastructure, compliance, legal, and the 10% every honest budget needs.

At this raise: 40-city verified coverage, iOS parity, a team of three — the point where the data advantage becomes hard to catch.

Built in the Himalayas. Priced for the person actually travelling.

Try it before you decide — that is the whole pitch.

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